

Akabare Panipuri: Prototype Rules v0.6

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What changed in v0.6

v0.6 adds a trap reward and removes the bid cap. Everything else carries over from v0.5.

- **Trap reward:** the owner of the Akabare that busts the eater gets +2.
- **No maximum bid:** Chaat counts as 2, so a bid can be higher than the number of puri on the table.
- **Empty table rule:** if every stack is empty, the eater can still flip remaining powers before busting.
- **Ownership tracking:** every puri card now carries an owner, so the trap reward can be paid.

The idea

Everyone secretly builds a stack of puri, and anyone can add to anyone's stack. Then the bidding starts. Only the highest bidder eats. They start with their own stack, then dig into others'. They can flip up to 2 power cards from anywhere on the table, but only their own is a known card. Bite an Akabare without the right power, and you're out.

- **Players:** 3 to 6
- **Goal:** reach 30 points first, or have the most points after 5 rounds.

Components

- **Puri set (per player):** 5 Panipuri and 1 Akabare, in the player's own color. Every player gets their full set back at the start of each round.
- **Power cards (per player):** Vinegar, Dahi, Khali Puri, Chaat.

Setup (every round)

1. **Build your stack.** Choose 2 puri cards from your set and place them face down, in any order, as your own stack. Only you know what they are. The other 4 stay in your hand.

2. **Place your power card.** Choose 1 power card and place it face down beside your own stack.

- Rounds 1 to 3: choose from power cards you haven't used yet.
- Round 4: all 4 come back. Choose any.
- Round 5: choose from the 3 you didn't pick in round 4.

3. **First player.** Chosen at random in round 1. After that, it rotates clockwise each round.

Every power card placed during setup counts as used for its owner, whether or not anyone flips it.

Round	Available	Example pick
1	Vinegar, Dahi, Khali Puri, Chaat	Vinegar
2	Dahi, Khali Puri, Chaat	Chaat
3	Dahi, Khali Puri	Khali Puri
4	All 4 reset	Vinegar
5	Dahi, Khali Puri, Chaat	Dahi

Serving

Starting with the first player and going clockwise, on your turn do one of these:

- **Place a puri card** face down on top of any stack, yours or someone else's.
- **Or start the bid.** Announce how many Panipuri you'll eat. Minimum 1.

Once the bid starts, nobody can place any more cards. If your hand is empty on your turn, you must start the bid.

Bidding

Going clockwise from the player who started the bid, each player either:

- **Raises** the bid by at least 1, or
- **Passes** and is out of the bidding for the round.

Bidding continues until only one player is left. That player is **the eater**. Nobody else eats this round.

There's no maximum bid. Since Chaat counts as 2, a bid can be higher than the number of puri on the table.

Eating

1. **Your own stack first.** Flip your stack from the top, one card at a time, until it's empty.
2. **Then others' stacks.** If you haven't completed your bid, keep going. Each flip, choose any other player's stack and flip its top card. You can switch stacks between flips.
 - Panipuri: counts as 1 eaten.
 - Akabare: you're out, unless a power card saves you.
3. **Use power cards.** At any point, flip up to 2 power cards from beside any stack. Your own, which you know. Or someone else's, which is a blind gamble.
4. **Stop when:**
 - You complete your bid. Success.
 - You bite an Akabare and aren't saved. Bust.
 - Every stack is empty, you're still short, and you have no power flips left or choose not to use them. Bust.

Power cards

Power	When to flip	Effect
Vinegar	Before a puri card	Numbs your tongue. The next card you eat is cancelled. An Akabare can't hurt you. A Panipuri doesn't count.
Dahi	Right after you bite an Akabare	The lifesaver. You're safe and keep eating. Flipped at any other time, it does nothing.
Khali Puri	Any time	An empty shell. Your bid goes up by 1. Bid 5, flip Khali Puri, now you need 6.
Chaat	Any time	Counts as 2 Panipuri eaten. Bid 4, eat 1, flip Chaat, you're at 3.

Biting an Akabare: you get one last chance. If you still have a power flip left, flip a power card. If it's Dahi, you're saved. Anything else, you're out. Vinegar can't save you after the bite. It only works before.

Scoring

Only the eater scores from the bid. Your final bid includes any Khali Puri increases.

- **Success:** + your final bid.
- **Bust:** minus your final bid.

Trap reward: if the eater busts on an Akabare, the owner of that Akabare gets **+2**. Ownership is shown by the card's color, no matter whose stack it was sitting on.

The trap reward doesn't apply when:

- The eater busts on their own Akabare.
- The Akabare was cancelled by Vinegar or neutralized by Dahi.
- The eater busts because every stack ran out.

End of round and winning

At the end of each round, everyone takes back their own puri cards, and the first player rotates clockwise.

If anyone has 30 or more points at the end of a round, the highest score wins. If nobody reaches 30, the highest score after round 5 wins.

Tiebreak: fewer busts across the game. Still tied, you share the win.

Examples

- **Vinegar saves you.** Sita suspects Ramesh planted his Akabare on top of his own stack. She flips her Vinegar first, then flips Ramesh's top card. It's the Akabare. Cancelled. She's safe.
- **Vinegar wastes a puri.** Anil flips Vinegar, but his next card is a Panipuri. It doesn't count.
- **The blind Dahi.** Priya bites an Akabare. She flips the power beside Anil's stack, hoping for Dahi. It's Chaat. She's out.
- **Chaat speeds you up.** Ramesh bids 4. He eats 1 Panipuri, then flips the power beside Sita's stack. It's Chaat. He's at 3 and needs 1 more.
- **Khali Puri backfires.** Priya bids 5 and gambles on the power beside Ramesh's stack. It's Khali Puri. Now she needs 6, and if she busts, she loses 6.

- **Chaat on an empty table.** Anil bids 7. Every stack is empty and he's eaten 5. He gambles his last power flip on Sita's power. It's Chaat. He's at 7. Success.
- **The planted chili.** Sita slips her Akabare onto Anil's stack. Ramesh wins the bid, clears his own stack, then flips Anil's top card. Akabare. He flips a power hoping for Dahi. It's Khali Puri. Ramesh busts, and Sita gets +2.

Prototype notes

Config

Setting	Value
TARGET_SCORE	30
MAX_ROUNDS	5
PLAYERS	3 to 6
SET_PER_PLAYER	5 Panipuri, 1 Akabare
STARTING_STACK	2
PLACE_PER_TURN	1
POWER_FLIPS_MAX	2
POWER_RESET_ROUND	4
MIN_BID	1
MAX_BID	none
TRAP_REWARD	2

Phases

1. SETUP
2. SERVING
3. BIDDING
4. EATING
5. SCORE, then next round or END

Actions

- **SERVING:** `PLACE_PURI(card, targetStack)` puts the card on top of any stack. `START_BID(amount)` ends serving.
- **BIDDING:** `RAISE(amount)` must beat the current bid. `PASS` is out for the round.
- **EATING (eater only):** `FLIP_PURI(stack)` uses own stack until empty, then any non-empty other stack. `FLIP_POWER(stack)` is allowed if fewer than 2 powers flipped and that power is face down. `ACCEPT_BUST` is available when an Akabare is pending, or when all stacks are empty and the eater is short.

Eating state

- `eaten` : Panipuri count, plus 2 for each Chaat
- `target` : bid, plus 1 for each Khali Puri
- `powersFlipped` : max 2
- `skipNext` : set by Vinegar, cleared after the next puri flip
- `pendingAkabare` : holds the bitten Akabare card. Only `FLIP_POWER` or `ACCEPT_BUST` allowed. Dahi clears it. Anything else means bust.
- Every puri card carries an `owner` field for the trap reward.

Resolution logic

```

on FLIP_PURI:
    card = stack.pop_top()
    if skipNext: skipNext = false; return
    if card == PANIPURI: eaten += 1
    if card == AKABARE:
        if powersFlipped < 2 and any power face down:
            pendingAkabare = card; return
        BUST(card)
    check_end()

on FLIP_POWER:
    powersFlipped += 1
    power = stack.power.reveal()
    if pendingAkabare:
        if power == DAHI: pendingAkabare = null
        else: BUST(pendingAkabare)
        return
    if power == VINEGAR: skipNext = true
  
```

```

if power == KHALI:    target += 1
if power == CHAAT:    eaten += 2
check_end()

check_end:
  if eaten >= target: SUCCESS (+target)
  if all stacks empty and eaten < target:
    if powersFlipped < 2 and any power face down:
      allow FLIP_POWER or ACCEPT_BUST
    else: BUST(null)

BUST(akabareCard):
  eater.score -= target
  if akabareCard and akabareCard.owner != eater:
    akabareCard.owner.score += TRAP_REWARD

```

UI suggestions

- Show each puri card's owner color on its back, so players know who placed what.
- Give each player a private reminder of which cards they placed and where.
- Make the "bite an Akabare, flip a power?" moment its own screen. It's the most dramatic beat in the game.
- Show a soft warning if a bid is higher than the most anyone could eat (Panipuri on the table + 4). Players can still confirm.

Still open

- ☐ **Target score vs. rounds.** Only one player scores per round, so 30 in 5 rounds is a stretch even with trap rewards. Watch the first playtests. Options: no round limit, or a target of 12 to 15.
- ☐ **Vinegar scope.** These rules assume Vinegar cancels only the next card.